

Secure Comms Setup Guide

Step-by-step setup for Signal, ProtonMail, and VPN for organizer teams.

Signal — Secure Messaging

- Download from signal.org/download (not from search ads — use the direct link).
- Register with a phone number. For high-risk work, use Google Voice or MySudo.
- Registration Lock PIN: Settings → Account → Registration Lock.
- Disappearing messages: open conversation → timer icon → 1 week.
- Group: set 2+ admins, enable admin-only join link, regularly audit membership.

ProtonMail — Encrypted Email

- Sign up at proton.me with a username that does not reveal your identity.
- Enable 2FA immediately: Settings → Security → Two-Factor Authentication.
- ProtonMail to ProtonMail = end-to-end encrypted automatically.
- For non-Proton recipients: use Password-Protected Emails for sensitive messages.
- Never access on public WiFi without a VPN.

VPN Setup

Recommended	Mullvad (anonymous payment) or ProtonVPN (audited, open source).
Avoid	Free VPNs — they profit by selling your data. Defeats the purpose.
When to Use	Always on public WiFi. When researching sensitive topics. When filing FOIA requests.
Kill Switch	Enable — cuts internet if VPN drops, preventing data leaks.
Verify	After connecting: go to dnsleaktest.com and confirm your real IP is hidden.

Burner Phone Protocol (High-Risk Actions Only)

- Buy prepaid phone with cash. Activate on public WiFi — NOT your home network.
- Never log into personal accounts on the burner.
- Install only Signal and Firefox + uBlock Origin.
- Keep powered off and in airplane mode when not in use.
- Destroy the SIM card when done — not just the phone.

Encrypted File Sharing

Small files	Signal file sharing (end-to-end encrypted).
Larger files	OnionShare — open source, peer-to-peer, no accounts. onionshare.org
Collaborative docs	CryptPad — encrypted Google Docs alternative. cryptpad.fr

Cloud storage	Proton Drive or Tresorit. Avoid Google Drive for sensitive materials.
<i>TIP: Best security tool = the one your team actually uses. Start with Signal and ProtonMail. Get those consistent before adding complexity.</i>	